

Don't sweat small stuff

In the olden days, stress may have meant more of the physical **hardships** of day-to-day **existence** in the absence of modern gadgets and **infrastructure**. When these were fulfilled, stress found root in the minds of people. More of it now is a result of expectations of quick results, and unfulfilled **aspirations**. Everything happens in its own time.

Remember Krishn's advice not to **hanker** after the **fruits** of efforts or the quality of the fruits either. Just do your duty, and after you have completed one task, go on to the next one. **Ultimately**, what matters is the quality and worth of your efforts.

Not all trees **blossom** or **bear fruit**, but all give shade. One's work may not **yield** desired results, but one would have the satisfaction of having done the work to the best of their ability. **Hold on to** this satisfaction and **let go** of desire to see results. Try this tested formula for mental **peace**.



Stress may result from the loss of someone close or the unacceptable behaviour of people near you. We are all on a journey, with the time of **boarding** and **alighting** different for each one. Just remember that you are here only for a few years, so it is best to do your duty with the **conviction** that every single **consequence** is **God-ordained**. Don't sweat the small stuff, because in the grand **scheme of things**, everything is small **stuff**. [Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

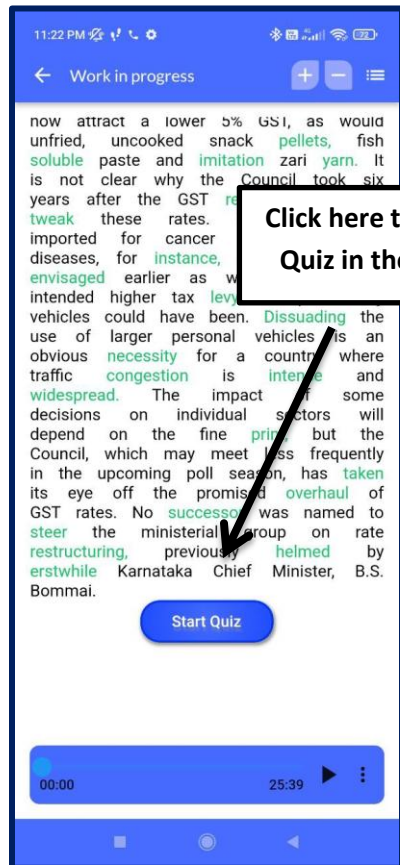
Vocabulary

1. **Sweat small stuff** (phrase) – worry over, stress about, obsess over, be anxious about, overthink छोटी बातों की चिंता करना
2. **Hardship** (noun) – adversity, difficulty, suffering, trial, struggle कठिनाई
3. **Existence** (noun) – life, being, survival, presence, living अस्तित्व
4. **Infrastructure** (noun) – framework, foundation, system, facilities, network अवसंरचना
5. **Aspiration** (noun) – ambition, desire, dream, hope, goal आकांक्षा
6. **Hanker** (verb) – crave, long, yearn, desire, want लालसा करना
7. **Fruit** (noun) – outcome, result, benefit, gain, product फल (परिणाम)
8. **Ultimately** (adverb) – finally, eventually, in the end, at last, conclusively अंततः
9. **Blossom** (verb) – bloom, flower, flourish, thrive, develop खिलना / विकसित होना
10. **Bear fruit** (phrase) – succeed, produce results, pay off, be fruitful, achieve result परिणाम देना
11. **Yield** (verb) – produce, generate, provide, give, return उत्पन्न करना
12. **Hold on to something** (phrase) – retain, cling to, keep, preserve, embrace बनाए रखना
13. **Let go** (phrase) – release, relinquish, discard, abandon, give up छोड़ देना
14. **Peace** (noun) – calm, tranquility, serenity, harmony, quietude शांति
15. **Boarding** (noun) – embarking, entering, getting on, access, departure चढ़ाई / चढ़ना
16. **Alight** (verb) – descend, disembark, get off, land, step down उतरना
17. **Conviction** (noun) – belief, certainty, confidence, faith, assurance दृढ़ विश्वास
18. **Consequence** (noun) – result, outcome, effect, aftermath, impact परिणाम
19. **God-ordained** (adjective) – destined, divinely planned, preordained, fated, heavenly नियत / ईश्वरनिर्धारित
20. **Scheme of things** (phrase) – the way things are organized or happen in a particular situation, or the way someone wants them to be organized सम्पूर्ण व्यवस्था
21. **Stuff** (noun) – things, material, matters, items, elements चीज़ें / वस्तुएं

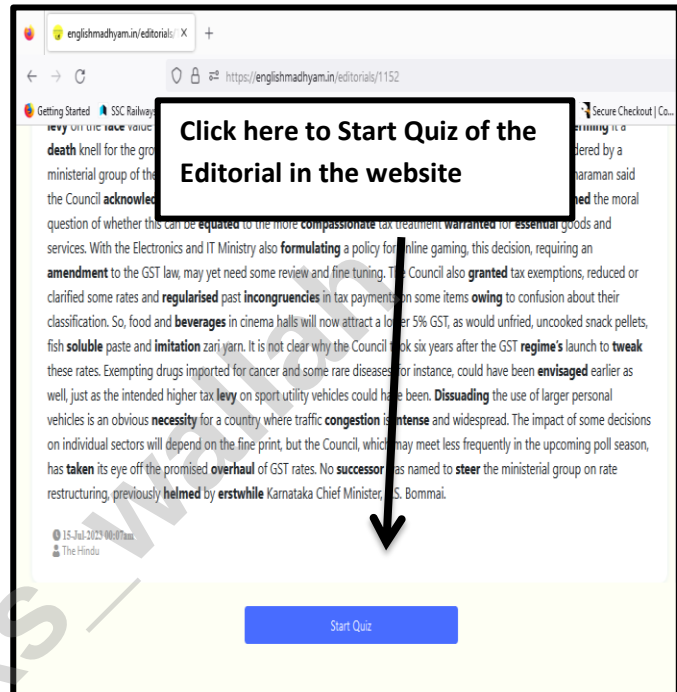
Summary of the Editorial

1. Old vs. Modern Stress: In earlier times, stress came from physical hardships, whereas today it arises from mental and emotional expectations.
2. Modern Triggers: Present-day stress is largely due to high expectations, urgency for results, and unfulfilled desires.
3. Philosophical Guidance: The article draws from Krishna's advice in the Gita — do your duty without attachment to results.
4. Focus on Action: Emphasis is on performing one's responsibilities sincerely, not worrying about the outcomes.
5. Value of Effort: It's the quality of effort that matters, not always the tangible results.
6. Metaphor of Trees: Like how not all trees bear fruit but still provide shade, not all efforts give results but still hold value.
7. Satisfaction in Work: There is inner peace in knowing one did their best, regardless of what was achieved.
8. Letting Go of Outcomes: The desire for specific results often leads to stress — learning to let go can bring calm.
9. Dealing with Loss or Hurt: Stress can also stem from loss or difficult relationships, but these are part of life's journey.
10. Life is Temporary: Life is described as a brief journey, where everyone has different entry and exit points.
11. God-ordained Consequences: Outcomes should be viewed as divinely determined, not fully in human control.
12. Embrace Acceptance: Accepting life's unpredictability helps lessen mental strain.
13. Duty with Conviction: Doing one's duty sincerely and faithfully is a recurring message throughout the piece.
14. Perspective on Problems: In the larger scheme of life, most problems are insignificant or "small stuff".
15. Formula for Peace: The key to mental peace is letting go of expectations, embracing duty, and adopting a broader life perspective.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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